CRPF. Nagrani confirmed to me the planned operation included an SFF unit and two Mi4 helicopters and the use of bulletproof vehicles to take Bhindranwale out of the complex from an adjoining road after he was captured. For that, Nagrani had requested a three-layered CRPF cordon of the area to be put in place just before the heliborne commandos were to strike.

Before the operation was planned, Nagrani selected a civilian employee of the SFF and assigned him the task of spending a few days at the Golden Temple complex. The employee's task was to prepare a detailed sketch map with special emphasis on the langar area and mark the most suitable points of entry and exit. He was also to observe the activities and movements of Bhindranwale and his armed guards from his residence in the Akal Takht to the langar complex rooftop. The observer was asked to suggest the most suitable time and place for Bhindranwale's abduction by heliborne commandos. With all this information gathered in three or four days, a model of the Golden Temple complex highlighting the langar area and nearby escape routes was prepared in Sarsawa near Saharanpur in Uttar Pradesh.

The following were the salient features of that operation:

Just before the heliborne commandos were to approach the Golden Temple complex, a sufficient number of armed CRPF personnel would throw a cordon around the complex to prevent entry and exit of people and material till the operation was over. Two teams of SFF commandos, travelling in two low-flying Mi4 helicopters, would approach the spot where Bhindranwale addressed his sermon on the roof, as his talk was about to end. Taking advantage of the lax security around Bhindranwale at that moment, the two teams would rope down.

Some of the commandos would rush towards Bhindranwale and grab him, while the rest would neutralize his armed security guards, who would naturally react as soon as they saw the commandos, possibly even before they had landed on the rooftop. Simultaneously, the remaining SFF commandos and CRPF personnel would divide themselves into two lots. One would enter the Golden Temple complex to block Bhindranwale's access to the sanctum, in case he escaped from the langar roof, and capture him.